

Noise: A Flaw in Human Judgment

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Corpus priority: Phase 1

Document type: Synthesized RAG source dossier built from publicly available online material

Purpose In This RAG Corpus

- Core foundation for inconsistency in judgment, not just directional bias.
- Directly applicable to hiring, legal systems, performance evaluation, claims handling, and governance.
- Introduces decision hygiene and noise audits, which are highly practical for enterprise decision-support design.

Key Concepts And Retrieval Tags

- noise
- level_noise
- pattern_noise
- occasion_noise
- decision_hygiene
- independent_assessment
- structured_judgment

Core Learnings

- Two judges can evaluate the same case differently for reasons unrelated to the merits of the case, and that variability is itself a serious error source.
- Judgment quality problems are not exhausted by bias; unwanted inconsistency can create unfairness, financial loss, and governance failure.
- Noise often remains invisible until organizations deliberately measure it.
- Decision hygiene reduces error by improving process structure rather than by trying to fix every bias directly in the moment.
- Independent judgments, structured criteria, aggregation, and the outside view are recurring methods for improving reliability.

Directions, Observations, And Implications

- Use the book's framework to explain why inconsistent hiring or case handling is a problem even when no obvious bias is visible.
- Build retrieval prompts that surface noise risks, not just named biases.
- Design evaluation rubrics, structured interviews, and review workflows around decision hygiene principles.
- Use the concept of a noise audit as an organizational intervention recommendation.

How This Can Be Applied In Decision Making

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How This Strengthens A Bias-Aware RAG System

- Extends the RAG system beyond cognitive bias into inconsistency, reviewer variance, and governance process quality.
- Supports comparison of human judgment noise with model drift, calibration, and operational inconsistency in AI systems.
- Provides strong grounding for recommendations about structured review and independent assessment.

Limitations And Cautions

- This dossier is based on the user-provided book text already in the repo plus public descriptions and tables of contents.
- It is still a synthesized guide, not a substitute for a licensed analytic extract.

Source Notes

- Project source PDF already present in repository (primary_text): local_repo_source
- MIT Press Bookstore description (publisher_description):
<https://mitpressbookstore.mit.edu/book/9780316322270-0>
- UNT library summary and table of contents (library_summary):
<https://discover.library.unt.edu/catalog/b7419582>

RAG Ingestion Note

This document is intentionally written as a concise, retrieval-friendly synthesis rather than as a book review. It is designed to help the system retrieve named biases and decision failures, practical mitigation methods, organizational and AI-governance implications, and scenario-to-concept mappings for user prompts.